

Pre-Flight Privacy Checklist

Farmer

Complete this checklist before every drone flight for crop monitoring and agricultural operations.

Job Details

OPERATOR NAME

DATE OF FLIGHT

FARM OWNER / MANAGER

LICENCE / RPA REG NO.

PROPERTY / Paddock NAME

WEATHER CONDITIONS

1 — Consent & Property Boundaries

- ☐ **Farm owner / operator consent confirmed**
If operating on behalf of another, written authorisation from the landowner obtained.
- ☐ **Neighbouring property boundaries identified and confirmed**
Cadastral boundaries reviewed; flight plan stays within the subject property.
- ☐ **Neighbouring land owners notified where flight path runs close to boundary**
Adjacent farmers or residents informed of planned flight date and area.
- ☐ **Agronomy service provider or agronomist notified (if applicable)**
Third-party agronomist receiving data briefed on privacy obligations for crop data.
- ☐ **Lease or tenancy arrangements considered**
If land is leased, both owner and tenant consent obtained where required.
- ☐ **Privacy Act obligations understood**
Operator aware that imagery may capture personal data of neighbouring property occupants.

2 — No-Fly Zones & Airspace

- ☐ **Airspace checked via CASA tool (Airshare / OneSky)**
No restricted, prohibited or controlled airspace within planned flight area.
- ☐ **NOTAM reviewed for flight date and time**
No active NOTAMs affecting the property.
- ☐ **Proximity to aerodromes confirmed**
5.5 km radius from controlled aerodromes checked; CASA authorisation obtained if required.
- ☐ **Flight within visual line of sight (VLOS) or BVLOS approval held**
VLOS maintained or BVLOS approval from CASA confirmed for large paddock or multi-paddock surveys.
- ☐ **Operating height at or below 120 m AGL (or approved altitude)**
Maximum planned altitude confirmed; crop height factored into AGL calculation.
- ☐ **Aerial agricultural spraying authorisation confirmed (if applicable)**
If applying chemicals, CASA Part 137 approval and relevant state/territory permits are current.

3 — Privacy Risk Assessment

- ☐ **Neighbouring residential dwellings and farm buildings assessed**
Homesteads, sheds and yards within or adjacent to the flight area identified and noted.
- ☐ **Flight path designed to avoid direct overflight of neighbouring homes**
Camera angle and altitude adjusted to minimise capture of private residential areas.
- ☐ **Farm workers and contractors present during flight notified**
All persons on the property aware of drone operation and approximate flight timing.
- ☐ **Livestock and animal welfare considered in flight planning**
Flight path avoids low passes over livestock; approach and departure routes assessed.
- ☐ **Signage at property access points considered for public notification**
Where public roads border the property, signage advising of aerial operations erected.

4 — Data Collection Limits

- ☐ **Data collection limited to the agreed paddocks / crop areas**
Flight plan boundary matches the monitoring brief; no collection outside subject parcels.
- ☐ **Imagery resolution appropriate to agronomic purpose**
GSD set to minimum required for crop health assessment; unnecessary detail of private areas avoided.
- ☐ **Crop yield, disease or soil data treated as commercially sensitive**
Agronomic data handled as confidential; not shared beyond the farming operation without consent.
- ☐ **Audio recording disabled**
Onboard microphone off for the duration of all agricultural flights.
- ☐ **Multispectral or thermal sensors used only as specified in the brief**
Specialist sensor use documented; data collection limited to agreed agronomic deliverables.

5 — Data Handling & Storage

- ☐ **SD card / storage media is blank before the flight**
No residual imagery or data from previous operations on recording media.
- ☐ **Imagery and agronomic data transferred to secure storage within 24 hours**
Encrypted drive or approved farm management platform with access controls.
- ☐ **Crop and soil data access restricted to authorised farm personnel**
Access log maintained; sharing with third parties (agronomists, insurers) requires consent.
- ☐ **Retention and deletion schedule agreed**
Data held for agreed season or contract period; deletion or archiving scheduled in writing.
- ☐ **Agronomic data not disclosed to third parties without owner consent**
Crop health maps, yield estimates and soil data not shared with other farms, buyers or government without approval.

6 — Equipment Pre-Flight Check

- ☐ **RPA registration / markings current and visible**
- ☐ **Battery charged at or above 80%; spare batteries checked**
- ☐ **Propellers inspected — no cracks or chips**
- ☐ **Return-to-home altitude set above tallest obstacle (trees, silos, power lines)**
- ☐ **Camera / sensor calibrated; lens clean**
- ☐ **Remote ID broadcasting confirmed (if required)**
- ☐ **Chemical spray tank empty and nozzles clear (if spray drone)**
- ☐ **Mission plan uploaded and waypoints validated in flight software**

7 — Post-Flight Actions

- ☐ **Imagery reviewed for unintended capture of neighbouring property or persons**
Flag any imagery showing identifiable people or private areas beyond the subject property.
- ☐ **Agronomic outputs reviewed before sharing with third parties**
Crop maps and reports checked; personal or commercially sensitive data redacted if required.
- ☐ **Incident log updated if any privacy, safety or airspace issue arose**
Record complaints, near-misses or unplanned captures; notify landowner if required.
- ☐ **Landowner / client provided with copy of this completed checklist**
Signed copy retained by operator for minimum 7 years.

Operator Sign-Off

By signing below I confirm all checklist items have been reviewed and completed to the best of my knowledge.

OPERATOR SIGNATURE

DRONE NAME